

Interview Story Card

Meat first, then stop. Say the point in two sentences, then let them ask.

YOUR DIFFERENTIATOR (OPEN WITH THIS)

"I have implemented the same kind of software from both sides of the table: as the vendor onboarding 80-plus clients, and as the customer leading a five-site ERP migration end to end."

SIGNATURE 1: EAST WEST (CUSTOMER-SIDE IMPLEMENTATION)

Claim "I led the ERP implementation and data migration that moved East West, a five-site global manufacturer, onto Aptean Intuitive."

Proof "I ran onboarding, compliance, financial, and training sessions for 150-plus users, supported the Mexico offices in person in El Paso and Juarez, and owned the ETL and data migration."

Relevance "That is this role: driving a structured implementation and keeping the customer moving through it, on schedule."

If asked re: layoff "My role wrapped when the migration finished and the team consolidated." One line, neutral, then move back to the work.

SIGNATURE 2: APTEAN (VENDOR-SIDE BREADTH)

Claim "At Aptean, the vendor itself, I implemented and supported 80-plus clients across the US, Midwest, and Europe."

Proof "I managed a wide range of configurations, from legacy on-premise to the cloud version of the same product, so I could never rely on one playbook."

Relevance "That range is exactly why I ramp quickly on any customer, no matter their setup."

THE FOUR MODES

Full Hook, Noticing, Action, Result, Bridge, Calibration. 60 to 90 seconds.

CART Context, Approach, Role, Transformation. Consulting, senior, and pre-sales rounds.

Short Result plus one line. When they are ready to move on.

PREP Point, Reason, Example, Point. Yes/no and under 20 seconds.

YOUR METHOD, WHEN THEY ASK IF YOU FOLLOW ONE

Discovery, then scope and requirements, then stakeholder alignment, then a milestone plan with checkpoints, then build and validate, then cutover and go-live, then adoption. Say it plainly. It reads as judgment, not a gap.

THE COMPRESS RULE

Over 90 seconds means you added setup. Cut to claim, proof, bridge. Kill the five tells: buried outcome, stream of consciousness, hedging ("I guess", "kind of", "just"), warm-up wandering, volunteering salary.

Story Selector: Which One, and the First Line

Read this before every interview. Selection under pressure is the whole game.

IMPLEMENTATION AND DELIVERY

Open Story 12 breadth as hook, Story 11 East West as proof.

First line "I have implemented the same kind of software from both sides of the table. At the vendor I delivered to 80-plus clients, and on the customer side I led a five-site ERP migration end to end."

Backups 7 parallel workstreams, 16 holding go-live, 9 migration setback, 6 Mexico sites, 22 rapid ramp.

Avoid Do not tell 15 and 17 in the same interview. Same engagement, two angles.

CUSTOMER SUCCESS AND ACCOUNT MANAGEMENT

Open Story 4 the \$1M recovery as hook, Story 18 the account you lost as depth.

First line "I protected about a million dollars in at-risk annual revenue inside a six-million-dollar book, and the loss I learned most from is the account I fixed technically and still lost."

Backups 8 churn redirect, 14 executive QBRs, 19 visibility and adoption, 12 both-sides breadth.

Avoid No quota ownership, no NRR or GRR attainment, no closed expansion dollars. You are commercially aware and post-sale revenue-adjacent.

PROGRAM AND PROJECT MANAGEMENT

Open Story 7 parallel workstreams as hook, Story 1 EFT/ACH as cross-functional proof.

First line "When everything is urgent I sequence around the critical path. On a hard-date warehouse and Robotics launch I had four workstreams competing, and everything converged on schedule."

Backups 15 scope surprise, 16 holding go-live, 21 opposing stakeholders, 20 request to release, 11 East West.

SOLUTIONS CONSULTING AND PRE-SALES

Open Story 12 breadth in PREP mode, Story 17 the CEO infrastructure conversation as proof. Use CART throughout.

First line "My edge is breadth on both sides of implementation. At the vendor I delivered to 80-plus clients from legacy on-premise to cloud, so I know where implementations break before they do."

Backups 15 scope surprise, 14 workshops and QBRs, 13 decision-first analytics, 22 rapid ramp, 4 the \$1M recovery.

THE 22, ONE LINE EACH

1 EFT/ACH: five-month, four-party payment replacement, restored compliant payments.

2 Robotics launch: parallel workstreams to a production-ready go-live with users trained.

3 Inventory automation: cut manual work 78 percent and discrepancies 22 percent with an audit trail.

4 \$1M recovery: protected \$1M at-risk revenue in a \$6M book by consolidating ownership.

5 SMS channel: stood up a zero-to-one support channel at Home Depot and made it repeatable.

6 Mexico sites: went on-site in El Paso and Juarez so they went live ready, not just installed.

7 Parallel workstreams: locked the data foundation first, held training last, hit the hard date.

8 Churn redirect: disagreed on root cause without arguing, reframed as shared fix, kept the account.

9 Migration setback: owned a data-mapping miss, rebuilt validation, added a checkpoint.

10 Hard feedback: told my updates ran long, rebuilt to outcome-first, meetings got shorter.

11 East West end-to-end: five sites, 150-plus users, onboarding through ETL to a clean go-live.

12 Both-sides breadth: 80-plus clients across three regions, vendor and customer side.

13 200-plus dashboards: defined the decision before building the view, so reports got used.

14 60-plus QBRs: built each session around what executives, operators, and delivery each needed.

15 13-month modernization: scoped for four to seven, named the infrastructure cost to the CEO up front.

16 Held a go-live: UAT defect would have broken a live workflow, held approval until validated.

17 CEO infrastructure: reframed hardware as implementation risk, not IT preference, got it funded.

18 The account I lost: fixed every issue raised, still churned to a cheaper competitor, hence proactive.

19 Out of spreadsheets: shadow tracking was a visibility gap, made the system show owner and next step.

20 Request to release: turned email-thread requests into backlog-ready work with UAT and validation.

21 Ops versus finance: made the tradeoff visible instead of winning, both sides stayed aligned.

22 Rapid ramp: learned the product through live client problems, 12 lifecycle implementations.

Cross-lane rules: Two full-mode stories per interview is the ceiling; everything else goes short or PREP. Do not reuse a story across rounds in the same loop, panels compare notes. Full bank with all four modes per story: interview_prep / Project Delivery Interview Stories.md